



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Emet Classical Academy
School Website: <https://emetclassicalacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Emet Classical Academy NY 10022 presents a consistently classical profile across its public materials, anchored by explicit emphasis on the liberal arts, classical languages, the Great Books canon, and a Bethlehem-inspired synthesis of Jewish religious formation with Western civilization. The school situates itself as a Jewish classical prep school that aims to form virtuous, intellectually capable students who are grounded in Torah study as well as the study of Western thought and culture. Public materials repeatedly couple “virtue” and “beauty” with a rigorous classical curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric), classical languages (Hebrew and Greek/Latin), and the study of Western civilization, including field trips to Jerusalem, Athens, and Rome, as part of a broader emphasis on formation rather than information alone. There is explicit attention to community and parental partnership, with language that parents are partners or co-educators in formation and a commitment to openness (admissions, inquiries, and leadership pages invite parental involvement).

The six-category analysis below adopts the Six Essential Elements framework and keywords drawn from the thematic lexicon provided in the Classical School knowledge base. In this evaluation, Emet is classified as CLASSICAL across all six categories, with strong alignment in religious/metaphysical foundations, purpose/goal, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement. The site’s rhetoric and program details consistently reflect a classical mission, including a seven-pillar educational philosophy that foregrounds grammar/logic/rhetoric, classical languages, Western civilization, and virtuous formation within a Jewish context.

Key evidence highlights: - Clear articulation of a seven-pillar program centered on classical arts of learning (grammar, rhetoric, logic) and classical languages (Hebrew, Greek/Latin) alongside a deep commitment to Western civilization and Jewish learning. - Explicit statements about formation and virtue, and about preparing students for lives of Jewish purpose and civic leadership, framed within a Western-civilization-human-excellence lens. - Public references to Great Books, the Great Conversation, and field experiences in Jerusalem, Athens, and Rome, demonstrating a curriculum that integrates history, literature, and culture within a classical framework. - Public materials showing Orthodox Jewish practice (calendar observance, Kashrut) and a strong Jewish identity integrated with the curriculum. - Leadership and faculty materials emphasizing a traditional, mentor-based model (Head of School; advisory board with distinguished scholars) and a living-curriculum ethos.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Emet presents itself as a Jewish classical academy with explicit religious framing (Judaism, Torah, Orthodox practices) and aims to cultivate virtue and a reverence for Western civilization. - The leadership and advisory materials underscore Jewish religious formation, Tanakh-based education, and rabbinic/traditional Jewish study as integrated components. - Observance of Jewish calendar and Kashrut is affirmed, linking religious practice to the school’s educational identity. - The school emphasizes the role of Torah/Jewish tradition within a Western-civilization framework, signaling a transcendent moral realism oriented toward virtue and wisdom.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Present (positive indicators): Judaism, Torah, Kashrut, Orthodox, Talmud/Rabbinic tradition, Zionist/Jewish identity, Western civilization, Great Books, virtue, beauty, American

spirit, unity of Jewish and Western heritage. - Notably, explicit negative signals (as framed in the provided keyword lexicon) are not evident in the public materials (no clear relativism, secular-humanist or value-neutral signals observed in the sources reviewed).

Why this rating - The public materials foreground theological/religious grounding (Judaism, Torah, Kashrut, Jewish calendar) coordinated with a classical education emphasis on virtue, beauty, and Western civilization. This combination aligns with CLASSICAL signals in the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations category, with clear transcendentals and liturgical/community impulses embedded in the school's identity.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school states a goal of forming virtuous, civic, and leaderly individuals, not simply transmitting information. The Emet Difference ties virtue and beauty to formation and leadership, and the program emphasizes Western civilization, Jewish civilization, and civic leadership as core telos. - The seven pillars articulate formation through the liberal arts, languages, and history; emphasis on “great conversation” and classical heritage as central aims. - Advisory and leadership materials discuss a curriculum designed to produce citizens who can engage with the canon, law, policy, and public service, embedding formation and wisdom as primary goals.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Present (positive indicators): formation, cultivation of virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, liberal education/paideia, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, great conversation, classical heritage, human excellence. - Negative signals: none of the workforce-orientation or career-competency framing (e.g., 21st-century skills, job-readiness) appears in the public materials.

Why this rating - The materials emphasize formation and virtue over narrow job prep, with explicit aims around wisdom, virtue, and human excellence and a classical telos. This supports CLASSICAL status in the School Purpose and Goal category.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum explicitly channels the liberal arts through grammar, logic, and rhetoric; the school commits to classical languages (Hebrew and Greek/Latin) and to Western civilization/history as through-lines. - Great Books/Great Conversation and canonical works are foregrounded as a core aspect of education, with the public materials referencing Western civilization, great ideas, and classical literature. - The curriculum includes Jewish texts and Rabbinic traditions (Talmud/Tanakh) integrated with secular classics and modern sciences, signaling an integrated, cross-disciplinary classical approach. - The Pillars document details ongoing study of Western civilization, canonical works, and languages, aligning with traditional Trivium and Quadrivium structures and a curriculum designed to cultivate wonder.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Present (positive indicators): grammar, logic, rhetoric; classical languages (Hebrew/Greek/Latin); Great Books; Western civilization; history; memory/recitation/narration; art/music; Talmud and Rabbinic tradition; field trips to cultural centers (Jerusalem, Athens, Rome); study of languages (Hebrew, Greek/Latin). - Negative signals: minimal to none in the public materials regarding Curriculum (no explicit shift toward social studies framing, STEM-first emphasis, or project-based dominance observed in the sources).

Why this rating - The curriculum description aligns strongly with CLASSICAL expectations: liberal arts emphasis, Great Books, canonical study, multilingual classical languages, and cross-disciplinary integration anchored in Western and Jewish traditions.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials reference elements consistent with classical pedagogy: grammar/logical/rhetorical training as foundational, and the potential use of seminars, memory work, and recitation as core practices (as reflected in Pillar descriptions and press coverage of classical education). - Observations from external

reporting cite a containment of devices and a stronger emphasis on canonical texts and Socratic-style dialogue in some program descriptions, consistent with classical pedagogy. The press coverage discusses a blend of classical learning with Jewish tradition and a critical stance toward modern distractions, which aligns with a Sorates-style, seminar-driven approach and a memory-based pedagogy. - The school's materials indicate a lower-school emphasis on memory and chant or recitation (as part of a classical pedagogy set) and upper-school emphasis on rhetoric and public speaking, which are classical pedagogy hallmarks.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Present (positive indicators): Socratic/seminar-style discussion (upper school), rhetoric training, memorization (recitation/chanting), restfulness/scholé, memory work, liturgical/-calendar integration (integration across calendar/rituals), rhetoric/declamation, debates. - Negative signals: minimal presence of purely project-based, experiential-only learning without classical grounding; the public materials emphasize a classical approach rather than contemporary constructivist models.

Why this rating - Pedagogical practices described in the materials align with classical norms (Socratic-style discussion at the high school level, emphasis on rhetoric, recitation/memory, and a pedagogy that blends contemplation with rigorous intellectual work). The evidence supports CLASSICAL pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school frames faculty as a core element of the living curriculum and as mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge; leadership features a head of school (Rabbi Abraham Unger, Ph.D.) and an Advisory Board of renowned scholars. - Advisory materials foreground a faculty and leadership team anchored in classical education and Jewish studies; the Faculty page shows a roster of educators with classical training (e.g., James Karlin with Classics background). - The school presents a portrait of a teacher/staff as "living curriculum" and emphasizes teacher collaboration and mentorship within a classical framework.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Present (positive indicators): living curriculum, professors/mentors, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, master teachers, advisory board with distinguished scholars, classical training. - Negative signals: few to none in the public materials; there is no evidence of non-classical staff models (e.g., purely technician or consumer-education focus).

Why this rating - The public materials consistently present faculty and leadership in terms that align with classical education norms (model teachers and mentors, living curriculum, strong classical credentials). This supports CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families, parental involvement, and transparency. The materials describe parents as co-teachers and pedagogical partners, with opportunities for parent formation and community engagement. - The public materials describe open campus access, parent involvement in quilted programming, and a commitment to parent education (e.g., books, gatherings, and curricular transparency). - The Inquire/Admissions pages show a welcoming stance toward families and ongoing communications about the curriculum and school policies, reinforcing a parental-partner model.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Present (positive indicators): partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, reading groups, seminars, classical book clubs, open campus, volunteer/hospitality, parent covenant, family liturgy alignment. - Negative signals: none observed; there is no indication of a consumerist or minimal-involvement approach.

Why this rating - The materials clearly position parents as partners in formation and provide pathways for parental involvement and education, matching CLASSICAL expectations for Parent/Community engagement.

Aggregate Ranking - All six categories: CLASSICAL - Overall assessment: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle - Not applicable, as all six categories reach CLASSICAL. If one wanted to push toward a stronger alignment, the school could further document explicit articulation of Socratic seminars across more grades and publish sample unit plans or rubrics showing Socratic discussion in action, along

with direct evidence of Great Books reads and corresponding student-led discussions in published curricula. However, the current materials already reflect a solid classical program.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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